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Head of Change National Security Group (Ref: 21849)

HM Prison & Probation Service

Apply before 11:55 pm on Thursday 17th September 2026



Reference number

479680

Salary

£91,540 - £105,912

The national salary is £91,540 - £100,694. London salary is £94,660 - £105,912. Your salary will be dependent on your base location

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Other
HMPPS Band 11

Contract type

Permanent

Type of role

Business Management and Improvement
Other

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

East Midlands (England), East of England, London (region), North East England, North West England, South East England, South West England, Wales, West Midlands (England), Yorkshire and the Humber

About the job

Job summary

This is a Nationally based role

Job description

HMPPS Band 11

We are seeking exceptional senior leaders to join our organisation at a pivotal time of transformation. These influential roles will play a key part in delivering strategic alignment projects, providing visible leadership through change, and shaping the future direction of the organisation. Working across complex stakeholder environments, successful candidates will build and maintain strong partnerships, drive operational improvement, and ensure the delivery of high-quality outcomes that support our long-term ambitions. This is a unique opportunity to make a lasting impact, leading people, performance, and change at the highest level.

National Security Group is leading on several major pieces of transformation in this sector. The Head of Change will oversee a portfolio of projects and workstreams. The post holder will be responsible for providing strategic leadership and governance to ensure the successful delivery of change programmes aligned to HMPPS priorities. The role includes oversight of portfolio assurance and driving improvements in project and portfolio management capability and best practice across HMPPS.

The most significant of these is the design and implementation of a multi-agency structure for the management of Serious and Organised Criminals (SOC) in the justice system. It is a high complex multi-agency project covering all prisons and probation delivery units across England and Wales and associated links with international equivalents. It seeks to bring together resource and capabilities from the National Crime Agency and Policing across the UK. Initially the role will lead the work to design both the services that this will deliver alongside the operating structure. Once agreed it will then lead the implementation of the work over the next two years. The role will also need to establish project management and governance structures for this work.

The project team is likely to consist of 20-30 staff of various grades and importantly from a variety of agencies across government. Working closely with senior stakeholders, the post holder will make decisions that support effective programme delivery and ensures change activity is aligned with organisational objectives and operational requirements.

This is a nationally based role with the standard HMPPS expectation around hybrid working and a minimum 60% office attendance. There will be frequent travel to London, occasional national travel and possible international travel.

Although the **Head of Intelligence, Head of Corruption, Crime and Policing Unit**, and **Head of Change NSG** roles are being advertised as three separate campaigns, they all sit within the National Security Group.

If you would like to be considered for more than one of these roles, please apply for each vacancy that interests you. We will conduct a joint sift across the campaigns, and candidates applying for multiple roles will only need to attend one interview.

We will share further details and guidance on the process in due course.

Developed Vetting standards required with a further STRAP accreditation.

The question for the presentation will be sent to candidates once they have been invited to interview.

Person specification

Please refer to the Job Description

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Communicating and Influencing

Leadership

Seeing the Big Picture

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £91,540, HM Prison & Probation Service contributes £26,519 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Access to learning and development

A working environment that supports a range of flexible working options to enhance your work life balance

A working culture which encourages inclusion and diversity

A [Civil Service pension](#) with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Annual Leave

Public Holidays

Season Ticket Advance

For more information about the recruitment process, benefits and allowances and answers to general queries, please click the below link which will direct you to our Candidate Information Page.

Link: <https://justicejobs.tal.net/vx/candidate/cms/About%20the%20MOJ>

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using [Success Profiles \(opens in a new window\)](#), and will assess your Behaviours and Strengths.

<https://justicejobs.tal.net/vx/candidate/cms/About%20the%20MOJ>

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a standard (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [developed vetting \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : SSCL Recruitment Enquiries Team
Email : moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@resourcing.soprasteria.co.uk
Telephone : 0345 241 5358
Recruitment team
Email : moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@resourcing.soprasteria.co.uk

Further information

Appointment to the Civil Service is governed by the Civil Service Commission's Recruitment Principles. If you feel a department has breached the requirement of the Recruitment Principles and would like to raise this, please contact SSCL (moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@gov.sscl.com) in the first instance. If the role has been advertised externally (outside of the Civil Service) and you are not satisfied with the response, you may bring your complaint to the Commission. For further information on bringing a complaint to the Civil Service Commission please visit their web pages: <http://civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk/civil-service-recruitment/complaints>

<https://jobs.justice.gov.uk/careers/JobDetail/21849?entityId=21849>

